

1 GAME OVERVIEW

OBJECTIVE Program underground movement, build mountains above ground, and control valuable stacks.

PLAYERS 2-4 | 45-60 min | Light strategy

WIN After 6 rounds, highest cumulative score becomes the Top Tunneler.

2 SETUP CHRONOLOGY

- A** Place the correct underground board in the box bottom for the player count.
- B** Insert the 4 corner supports, then place the matching above-ground board on top; align coordinates.
- C** Each player chooses a mole and takes all matching molehill pieces.
- D** In turn order, place each mole on a different unoccupied edge space underground and choose its facing.
- E** Place 1 matching molehill directly above each starting mole.
- F** Shuffle movement/action cards. Create the face-up draft market.
- G** Place the rock token, rock die, scoring items, and turn-order pieces nearby.
- H** Confirm the board layers match and every mole is aligned with the starting molehill above.

3 STRUCTURE OF A ROUND

PHASE 1 - DRAFT
Take turns drafting from the face-up market until every player has 4 cards.



PHASE 2 - PLAN
Simultaneously order all 4 cards face down, first action on top. Lock the sequence.



PHASE 3 - ACT
In turn order, reveal and resolve one card each. Continue until all programmed cards resolve.



PHASE 4 - SCORE
Score 1 point per piece in every mountain you control. Then determine next round turn order.

ROUND HEIGHT LIMITS
R1: 2 | R2-3: 3 | R4-5: 4 | R6: 5
Exceeding the limit causes an immediate topple.
All mountains remain between rounds.

4 SETUP VISUAL



Two aligned boards: movement below, mountains above
Keep mole and above-ground coordinate synchronized.

1 KEY MECHANICS

PROGRAM Once the 4-card stack is set, its order cannot change.

MOVE Rotate or move 1-3 spaces straight ahead as shown. A mole faces the direction of its nose.

BLOCKED Another mole or the board edge stops movement; remaining movement is lost.

BUILD After entering each new underground space, add your piece to the bottom of the matching mountain above.

SUPPLY If short on pieces, reclaim your pieces from mountain tops or place only what remains.

ROCK Rock actions place or move the rock and roll the die. A mole hitting it turns as directed.

PEEK A Mole/Peek action topples the mountain directly above that mole.

TOPPLE Bottom piece stays. All pieces above cascade one per space in one orthogonal direction chosen by the triggering player.

CONTROL The color on the bottom controls the entire mountain, regardless of colors above.

2 SCORING SUMMARY

DURING GAME At the end of every round, score each mountain you control.

VALUE Score 1 point for every piece in each controlled mountain.

OWNERSHIP Only the bottom piece determines control.

TURN ORDER After scoring, choose next round order beginning with the player who has the most pieces on top of mountains.

NO RESET Mountains remain, so later rounds usually offer more points.

4 END OF GAME

- Finish Round 6 and complete its scoring phase.
- Add all points earned across the 6 rounds.
- Highest total is the Top Tunneler and wins.
- Tie resolution is not specified in the supplied summary; consult the rulebook if needed.

3 STRATEGIC TIPS

GOOD HABITS

- Plan fallback routes because opponents and rocks can invalidate later cards.
- Target tall mountains: control scores every piece, not just your color.
- Use movement to slide your color under valuable existing stacks.
- Check the round height limit before placing each piece.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Adding new pieces to the top instead of the bottom.
- Changing programmed order after an opponent acts.
- Continuing movement after hitting a mole, rock, or edge.
- Forgetting that a Peek action topples the mountain directly above.

COMPETITIVE TIPS

- Topple to spread ownership opportunities and disrupt tall enemy mountains.
- Balance first action access against the value of moving last.
- Watch top-piece counts because they influence next round turn-order choice.
- Protect bottom control while steering rivals into blocked routes.

FAST CHECK: bottom controls - every piece scores
Build below | topple outward | score each round